



## **PCRD ORGANIZATIONAL BACKGROUND:**

### **Profile:**

The Palestinian Center for Research and Cultural Dialogue (PCRD) was founded in 2003 by a group of Palestinian academics in the Palestinian territories. It is registered by the Palestinian Ministry of Interior under number BL.357.CU. We play an essential role in bridging the gap between different peoples and cultures towards a just and lasting peace in the region. **We also try to dig deep in history and focus attention to the ancient (since 10,000 B.C.) and successive civilizations that were established in Palestine and communicate them to the entire world.** PCRD also works on disseminating civilized and peaceful concepts of resolving conflicts within the Palestinian society, and conducting surveys to probe tendencies of Palestinians vis-à-vis a broad spectrum of issues of concern in the Palestinian society. The PCRD thinks highly of the youth's capacity in changing things on the ground. That is why we mainly work and focus on youth issues so that they participate in the development process.

#### ***1.1 Name of organization, contact information, contact person***

**Key Contact Person:** Dr. Walid Shomaly-Executive Director

PCRD (Palestinian Center for Research and Cultural Dialogue, Address: Beit Sahour - Palestine.

Telephone: **0599318293**

E-mail: **wshomaly@pcrd.ps**

**[info@pcrd.ps](mailto:info@pcrd.ps)**

Website: **[www.pcrd.ps](http://www.pcrd.ps)**

#### **2. About PCRD:**

##### ***2.1. Name, official status and registration (Please enclose documentation as evidence)***

Palestinian Center for Research and Cultural Dialogue (PCRD), Registered at the Ministry of Interior under the number: BL.357.CU

## **2.2 Mission of organization (i.e. mandate or general objectives)**

The PCRD seeks to be distinguished and a pioneer in developing and strengthening the youth and promoting research for the sake of building a democratic society. Also, probing the trends of Palestinian society regarding several issues.

### **PCRD mission**

The center's mission is to promote dialogue between social, political and cultural groups as a means of conflict resolution, accepting differences between peoples, citizenship, and respecting other's convictions. The center with this belief, directs its projects and programs to young men and women from different social, economic and political affiliations, and exerts utmost efforts to employ modern technology in disseminating democracy in this globalized world. Highlighting the successive ancient civilizations of Palestine and having youth acquainted with them.

The philosophy of the PCRD is mainly based on the rights of people to civic education, intellectual education and expression of opinion. Therefore, activities include five main tracks:

#### **First Track:**

Civic education in terms of democracy, human rights, individual and public freedoms, citizenship, pluralism, political systems, thought openness and enlightening, social accountability and good governance. These concepts are implemented via brainstorming meetings, seminars and training. Therefore, youth are trained and educated on the following;

- Civic education on social accountability.
- Civic rights and rights of citizenship.
- Mechanisms, tools and principles of accountability, monitoring and protection of rights.
- Citizenship.
- Pluralism and acceptance of the other and their opinion.
- Promoting the role of youth in public life and political participation.
- Promoting good governance and social accountability.

In addition, a specialized program pertaining to local government under the title "Global Cities" will soon be incorporated. It includes the following:

- Promoting financial sustainability and enhancing service quality.
- Developing resources for the urban assembly and developing local economy of the urban agglomeration.
- Strengthening capabilities and skills in strategic planning and crisis planning.
- Empowering and raising the capabilities of human resources in municipalities.

- Enhancing the exchange of experiences and communication among municipalities and their participation in joint programs.
- Establishing an electronic platform for training and raising capabilities on virtual training.

### **Second Track:**

Intellectual education through targeting both students and teachers at academic centers and institutions for the sake of instilling in their mind human values and training them on critical thinking rather than rote learning. This will create open-minded people capable of carrying out creative thinking and logical analysis.

### **Third Track:**

Carrying out research studies, surveys and polls . The PCRDR emphasizes studies related to cultural, development and intellectual reality in Palestine while probing the public opinion on related issues. The center and in cooperation with a bunch of competent intellectuals and researchers to achieve the following objectives:

- To contribute in disseminating democracy, human rights and public freedoms.
- To render consultations in line with the mission of the center. Also, to carry out surveys via data collection through different tools i.e. surveys, focus group sessions or interviews.
- Carrying out research projects using optimum criteria and the scientific method.

### **Fourth Track:**

- Conducting need assessment studies via implementing baseline studies on various issues.
- Conducting formative research studies i.e. to provide up-to-date information to an already running study to strategically develop it on a sound basis as well as to pinpoint and probe trends and convictions of people towards essential and vital issues.
- Carrying out participatory rapid appraisal studies where problems are analyzed and identified towards possible solutions. In addition, we hold multi-stakeholder workshops where we focus on core problems, further define causes and develop a problem analysis diagram.

### **Fifth Track:**

- Revealing ancient and successive civilizations of Palestine.
- Educating Palestinian youth about their rich and versatile history.
- Communicating to the entire world the richness of the ancient civilizations of Palestine.
- Exchanging experience and information with people worldwide in terms of the versatile cultures and civilizations.

### **PCRDR Objectives:**

1. Holding research studies related to various topics in the Middle East in general and in Palestine in particular.
2. Holding seminars, meetings, and workshops to discuss the various aspects of the Arab Islamic Culture with the participation of local and foreign scholars. These activities are meant to create a better image of the Arab Islamic society in the Western World.
3. Carrying out public opinion surveys on political, social, economic, and cultural issues. Also to monitor and run surveys as to services rendered by municipalities and other organizations to the public.
4. Holding several meetings, seminars and colloquia on civic related issues i.e. democracy, human rights, individual and public freedoms, citizenship, pluralism, political systems, thought openness and enlightening, social accountability and good governance.
5. Training school teachers and students on the critical thinking and analytical approach.
6. Having the media deeply involved in promoting social accountability and community intervention.
7. Holding workshops to allow for adequate media intervention to promote the role of the Palestinian public in public affairs and realizing social accountability in the framework of citizenship in terms of both rights and duties. Indeed, Maan News Agency is an essential partner of the PCRDR.
8. Implementing civic education programs to raise the awareness of the public in general and youth in particular on all related topics.
9. Receiving international delegations and holding workshops with them for the sake of strengthening tolerance among different religions.
10. Disseminating concepts of peaceful methods of conflict resolution.
11. Translating studies on cultural dialogue from foreign languages to Arabic and vice-versa.
12. Holding Focus Group sessions for Palestinian youth, in order to educate them about the principles of dialogue and cultural exchange.
13. Educating youth about ancient civilizations in Palestine.
14. Strengthening capabilities in city management within the specialized program of "Global Cities".

### **2.3 Staff composition (gender etc) and capacity (professional background, qualification of key staff in cultural, psychosocial or other relevant fields)**

The PCRDR carries out its activities through its main office in Bethlehem and through a team of employees and volunteers throughout the West Bank and Gaza Strip. The PCRDR has a board of directors and an executive body.

### *Past Experience*

| <b>Project Title/Theme</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Location</b>    | <b>Partners</b>                                             | <b>Period/ Status (compl./ ongoing)</b> |
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| The project entitled “Enhancing CSO Operational Space through Strategic Dialogue, Toolkit Development and Capacity Building                                                                                                                                                                            | Jerusalem          | <b>Union of Charitable Societies - Jerusalem (UCS)</b>      | Feb at June 2026                        |
| Raising Awareness Sessions of families on Disability Inclusion Project “Towards an inclusive ECD : Comprehensive support to children with developmental delays and disabilities in the occupied Palestinian Territory “<br>In favor of Handicap International – Humanity & Inclusion 396 Training hour | Hebron & Bethlehem | Arab Society for Persons with Disability (ASPD) – Jerusalem | Nov 2025 at Feb 2026                    |
| A study of the impact of the detention experience on Palestinian children                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | West Bank          | YMCA                                                        | Feb at May 2025                         |
| Skill Up Building a Sustainable Economic in Bethlehem Governorate a needs assessment study                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Bethlehem          | Bethlehem Chamber of Commerce & Industry (BCCI )            | Dec 2024 at Mar 2025                    |
| A Study on the Impact of Policies and Procedures on Civil Society Organizations in Jerusalem " Civil Society Empowerment for Social Change in Jerusalem: Strengthening Grassroots Networks and Partnerships                                                                                            | Jerusalem          | Union of Charitable Societies - Jerusalem (UCS)             | Nov 2024 at Feb 2025                    |
| Baseline study “A project called Integrated water resources management and improvement of living conditions for rural households in the West Bank - phase 2. (IWRM)”                                                                                                                                   | West Bank          | Al-Ard for Agricultural Development                         | Sep 2024 at April 2025                  |
| Report on the Social and Economic Needs Assessment for Women and Young Women in Bedouin Communities As part of the project “Improving the Social and                                                                                                                                                   | East Jerusalem     | Roles for Social Change Association - ADWAR                 | June at Oct 2024                        |

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| Economic Situation of Bedouin Women in East Jerusalem”                                                                                                                                                                           |                         |                                                     |                        |
| Evaluation for the “SANAD-Empowerment and Support for Jerusalemite Women and Youth” project. The main goal of the project was to promote democracy, human rights, and gender justices for women, youth and children in Jerusalem | Jerusalem               | Al Saraya Centre for Community Services (Al Saraya) | Dec. 2022 at Jan 2023  |
| Examining the Psychological and Social Conditions and Needs in the West Bank communities, including East Jerusalem                                                                                                               | West Bank               | Terre des Hommes Palestine                          | Sep at Dec. 2022       |
| Baseline Study Report Women lead the change Implemented by TAM Funded by AWDF                                                                                                                                                    | West Bank               | Women's Media and Development Society – TAM         | May at Sept. 2022      |
| Final evaluation for the “Psycho-Social support and Protection Program for Children, Youth and Women in the Old City of Jerusalem” Project                                                                                       | Jerusalem               | Al Saraya Centre for Community Services (Al Saraya) | Dec. 2021 at Jan 2022  |
| Baseline Study and Evaluation assessment: SANAD-Empowerment and Support for Jerusalemite Women and Youth « To promote democracy, human rights, and gender justices for women, youth and children in Jerusalem                    | Jerusalem               | Al Saraya Centre for Community Services (Al Saraya) | Sep 2021 at Jan 2022   |
| study on Status of Agricultural Workers Rights in Palestine                                                                                                                                                                      | WB                      | UAWC- Union of Agricultural Work Committees         | April 2021 at Sep 2021 |
| Palestine Ancient Civilizations Project” was established by youth                                                                                                                                                                | Palestinian Territories | Local stakeholders                                  | 2020                   |

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| volunteers. A pertinent committee was also established.                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                          |                                                                        |                                                                                                        |
| Towards social inclusion in community development by providing platforms for planning and advocacy                                                                                                                                                                | Jerusalem                | Union of the Charitable Societies-Jerusalem                            | Dec. 2019 at March 2020                                                                                |
| Networking between NGOs in the West Bank and Gaza Strip in preparation for the future Palestinian state. The project included several workshops and on the Skype with Gaza and its subtitle was “ The impact of the Palestinian political divide on civil peace”. | West Bank and Gaza       | Palthink-Gaza                                                          | June at Dec. 2018                                                                                      |
| Civic Education for Youth”                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | West Bank                | Friedrich Naumann Foundation                                           | July at November 2018                                                                                  |
| baseline study was conducted to assess the services of “Khalet Al-Mayyeh” local council in the population agglomeration of that area along with other six localities all located in south of Hebron.                                                              | Khalet Al Mayya - Hebron | “Khalet Al-Mayyeh” local council                                       | May 2018,                                                                                              |
| Holding awareness, media and societal campaigns” as a partial fulfillment of a program entitled” Reviving Historic Centers in Local Government Councils                                                                                                           | West Bank                | The Applied Research Institute of Jerusalem-Arij and Maan News Network | the first phase i.e. January 2018.<br><br>The second phase of the project was conducted in April 2018. |
| The project that included 144 Palestinian centers and associations in the Gaza Strip and the West Bank including East Jerusalem                                                                                                                                   | West Bank and            | AFRAT-France                                                           | April at June 2018,                                                                                    |

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Gaza Strip                            |                                                                                                                                            |                                      |
| Food Security Improvement Project<br>Though Agro-ecological Practice in<br>Al-Makhroun Area (Beit Jala)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Beit Jala                             | Caritas-Jerusalem                                                                                                                          | July -<br>September<br>2018          |
| Research on the right of Palestinians<br>to access their land, historic sites<br>and natural reserves as                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Heritage<br>sites of the<br>West Bank | conducted a research<br>study for the Swiss<br>Church Aid and ABC<br>consulting                                                            | July 21 at<br>September 1st,<br>2017 |
| Inclusive decisions at the local level<br>(IDEAL) programme baseline study.<br><br>The project was to run a survey on<br>the services rendered by<br>municipalities in the West Bank<br>especially those funded by the<br>Holland VNG                                                                                                        | West Bank                             | KIT-Sustainable<br>economic<br>development and<br>Gender (KIT) –<br>Holland<br>commissioned by the<br>Dutch municipality<br>Federation VNG | May 2017                             |
| A Baseline Study Entitled<br>“Leveraging media initiatives to<br>promote participatory engagement in<br>the peace process”                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | West Bank<br>and Gaza<br>Strip        | Maan News Agency                                                                                                                           | May 2017                             |
| Civic Education and training for<br>youth:<br><br>During this four-year period, the<br>FNF has funded a training on a<br>yearly basis for youth on various<br>dimensions of civic education that<br>included pluralism, democracy,<br>human rights, lobbying and<br>advocacy ...etc.<br><br>Each year included 10 sessions, 4<br>hours each. | West Bank                             | Friedrich Naumann<br>Foundation-FNF                                                                                                        | January 2013-<br>January 2017        |



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| Religious attitudes of Palestinian youth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | West Bank and Gaza          | Palestinian Center for Public Opinion-PCPO | November 2015                |
| Bridges : A training project funded by the GIZ and aimed at promoting the sense of citizenship among refugees and help them better integrate in the Palestinian society. Both refugee and non-refugee youth participated in the project.                                                                                                                                 | West Bank                   | 20 CSOs                                    | November, 2011-December 2012 |
| <p>Critical Thinking for school teachers:</p> <p>This was a training course funded by the French AFD to train the teachers of the Evangelical Lutheran School in Beit Sahour so that they train their students on the critical thinking rather than the rote learning method.</p>                                                                                        | Bethlehem, Hebron and Jenin | Ministry of Education                      | March at December, 2011      |
| <p>Promoting the role of Civil society in political participation phase 2:</p> <p>This was a series of training sessions for CSOs in the northern part of the West Bank. The sessions were meant to train those in charge of those organizations on how to actively and politically participate in the Palestinian arena that witnessed drastic and dynamic changes.</p> | North of West Bank          | 10 CSOs in North of West Bank              | Feb-July, 2011               |
| Pal-democracy II: An online training on promoting democracy for youth.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Bethlehem, Jenin and Nablus | Hanns Seidel Foundation                    | September-December, 2010     |
| Promoting the role of Civil society in political participation phase 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | WB                          | 10 CSOs                                    | March at September, 2010     |

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| Paldemocracy : An online training on promoting democracy for youth .                                                                                                                                     | West Bank          | Hanns Seidel Foundation                | March 2009 at April, 2010        |
| Public Opinion Survey on the “role of Media in promoting good governance”                                                                                                                                | West Bank and Gaza | Maan News Agency                       | March 2009                       |
| Civic Education and capacity building for youth and women centres Phase 1                                                                                                                                | Behlehem Area      | Fredrich Naumann Foundation            | January 2009 at June 2009        |
| Civic Education For Palestinian Youth<br><br>This training included Training of youth on several aspects of civic education i.e. democracy, lobbying and advocacy, elections , accepting the other...etc | Bethlehem          | National Endowment For Democracy – NED | January 2008 at January 2009     |
| Deep Learning Through Critical Thinking: Training held for 10th Grade Students to equip them with a creative technique of learning other than the traditional rote learning method.                      | Bethlehem          | French General Consulate-Jerusalem     | May 2007- May 2008               |
| Civic Education for Palestinian Youth<br><br>This training included Training of youth on several aspects of civic education i.e. democracy, lobbying and advocacy, elections, accepting the other...etc  | Bethlehem          | National Endowment for Democracy –NED  | September 2006 at September 2007 |
| Reach Out for Youth to Increase The Level Of Co-Existence In Bethlehem Area                                                                                                                              | Bethlehem          | TAMKEEN- A USAID                       | March at July 2005               |